EXPERIMENT 9 - LAB RECORD

Exploring AI-Assisted Features and Built-In Analytics (Zia) in Zoho Creator

Dashboard, Kanban report and Zia assistant for the Appointment_Booking_Form application

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Application	Appointment_Booking_Form (Zoho Creator)
Platform	Zoho Creator (low-code) with Zia, Zoho's AI assistant

1. Aim

To explore the built-in analytics and AI-assisted features of Zoho Creator by reviewing the application's dashboard, a Kanban report and a list report, and by asking Zia (the Build Agent) to add conditional formatting, in order to understand how form data becomes visual insight with little or no custom code.

Objectives

- Review the Hospital_Appointment_Dashboard, which combines a chart and a report.
- Study the Kanban report appointment_report, grouped by Department.
- Review the list report Appointment_Booking_Form Report as the source data.
- Try Zia to apply conditional formatting and record the result honestly.

Software and tools

- Zoho Creator with the Appointment_Booking_Form application
- Web browser with internet access
- Zoho account with access to Edit and Access (live) modes

2. Theory

Built-in analytics. Zoho Creator turns form records into summaries without a separate BI tool. A dashboard can combine charts and embedded reports; a Kanban report groups records into columns by a chosen field; and list reports show the underlying records. All of them read live data from the application's forms, so they update automatically when records change.

Zia. Zia is Zoho's AI assistant. In Creator the Build Agent accepts plain-language instructions about forms, reports and dashboards and applies them to the application. It can apply changes directly to the live app, and it may report an error when a requested change cannot be configured.

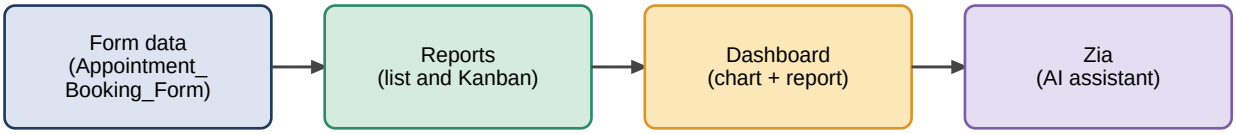


Fig. 1: From form data to reports, dashboard and Zia.

Concept	Meaning
Dashboard	A page that combines charts and embedded reports into one overview of application data.
Chart	A visual element, such as a bar chart, that summarises records by a chosen field.

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Concept	Meaning
Kanban report	A board-style report that groups records into columns by a field such as Department.
List report	A table of the records stored in a form.
Conditional formatting	A report rule that colours cells or rows by value so patterns stand out.
Zia (Build Agent)	An AI assistant that applies plain-language instructions to the application.

Parameter	Detail
Application	Appointment_Booking_Form
Form fields	Patient name, Age, Gender, Email, Contact number, Residential address, Referred by
Dashboard	Hospital_Appointment_Dashboard: Appointment_Booking_Form Report (View button), age chart by department, appointment_report
Kanban report	appointment_report, columns grouped by Department
List report	Appointment_Booking_Form Report (8 records)

3. Procedure

1. Open the dashboard — Open the application in Access mode and click Hospital_Appointment_Dashboard. It shows the Appointment_Booking_Form Report with a View button, a chart of age by department and the appointment_report below it.

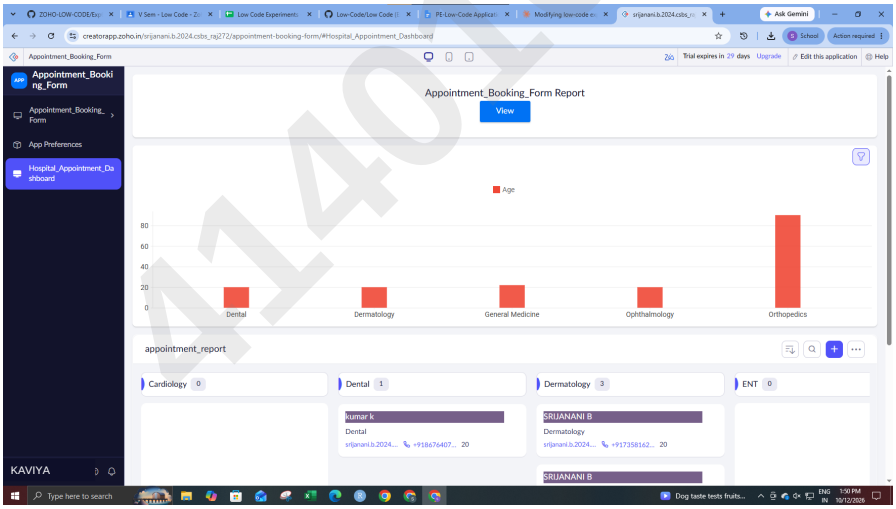


Figure 9.1: Hospital_Appointment_Dashboard

2. Check the Kanban properties — In Edit mode open appointment_report. Under Kanban Properties the report is grouped by Department, empty and deleted value columns are hidden, columns sort ascending and the record count per column is shown.

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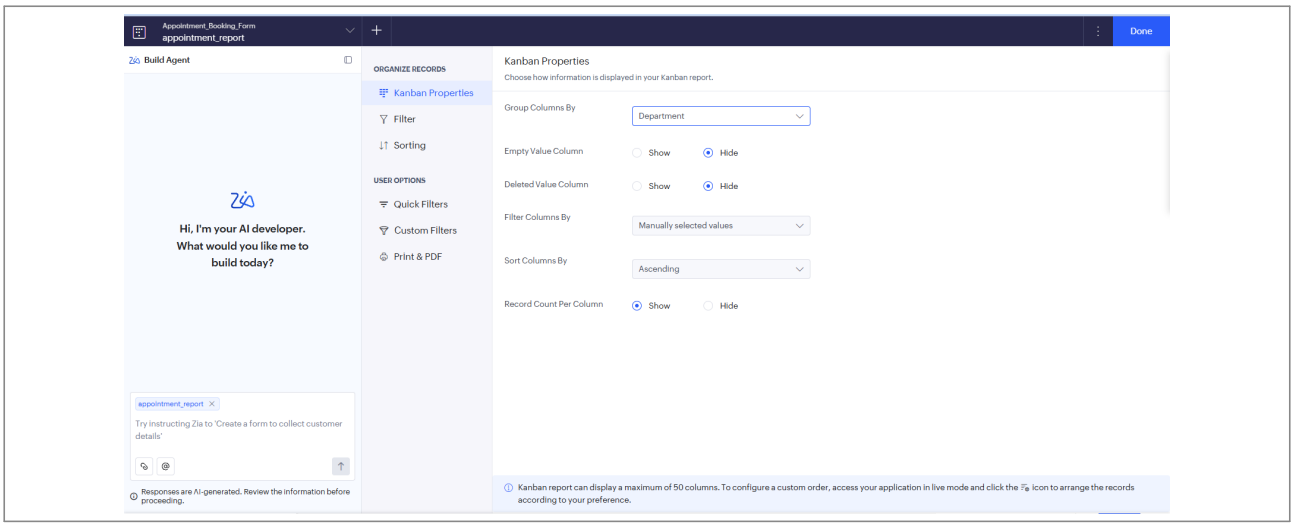


Figure 9.2: Kanban Properties of appointment_report

3. View the Kanban board — Open appointment_report in Access mode. Records appear as cards under department columns: Cardiology 0, Dental 1, Dermatology 3 and ENT 0, with empty columns labelled "No Records".

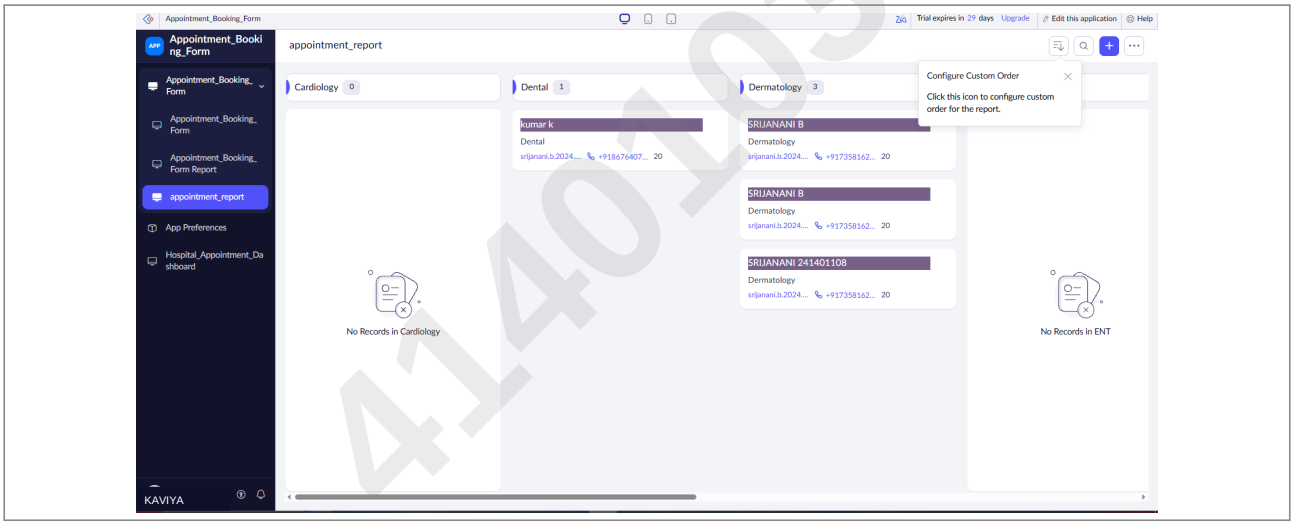


Figure 9.3: appointment_report Kanban board

4. Review the list report — Open Appointment_Booking_Form Report. It lists all 8 records with patient name, address, age, gender, email, contact number and referral source. This is the data the chart and board are built on.

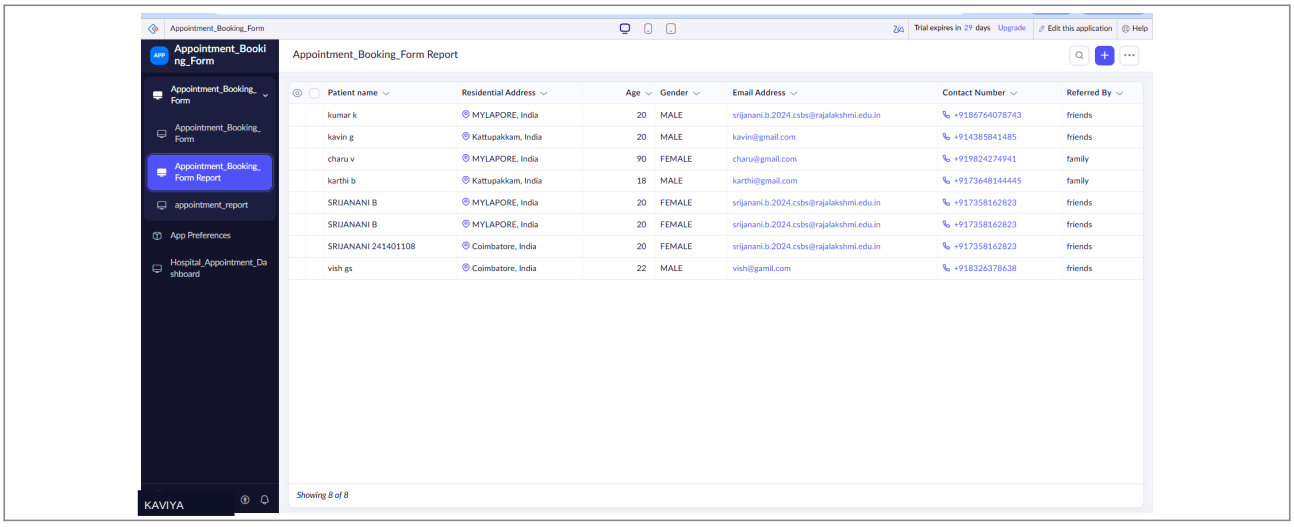


Figure 9.4: Appointment_Booking_Form Report

5. Ask Zia to add conditional formatting — In the Build Agent chat the instruction was entered: colour the Department column red when it is Orthopedics and green when it is Dental. Zia replied that it cannot currently configure conditional formatting for this report because of a schema validation error and advised setting it up manually.

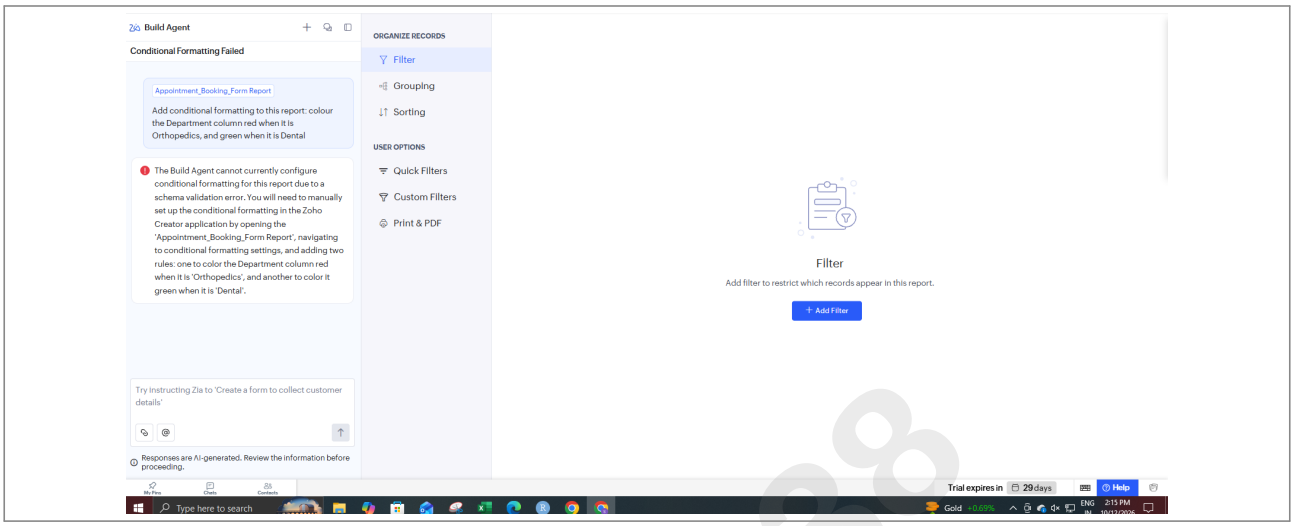


Figure 9.5: Zia reply - Conditional Formatting Failed

Note: a manual conditional-formatting option was not found in the report builder screens used in this experiment (the report menu offered only Rename, Duplicate and Delete), so conditional formatting was not applied.

4. Observations

- The dashboard combines a chart and a live report on one page without custom code.
- The Kanban board groups the same appointment records by Department and shows a count per column; Dermatology holds the most records (3).
- The list report shows all 8 records, which are the single source for the chart and the board.
- Zia could not apply the conditional-formatting request, so AI-assisted changes should be checked and may need manual setup.

5. Result

- The Hospital_Appointment_Dashboard was reviewed, with its chart and embedded report.
- The Kanban report appointment_report was reviewed in Edit and Access modes.
- The Appointment_Booking_Form Report was reviewed as the underlying data.
- Zia was tried for conditional formatting; it returned a schema validation error and the formatting was not applied.

6. Conclusion

The experiment showed how Zoho Creator's built-in analytics turn form records into a dashboard, a Kanban board and list reports without custom charting code, all driven by the same form data. Zia can accept plain-language instructions, but in this case it could not configure conditional formatting, which shows that AI-assisted changes need to be verified and sometimes completed by hand.

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